

# Politics

(Edexcel)

The beauty of Politics is that it is a living, breathing and ever-changing subject and it enables students to understand and orientate themselves in the world in which they live. We live in an exciting and dynamic world and are exposed daily to the changing nature of our society. 24-hour news and current affairs occur not just in our national newspapers but in front of our eyes. So often students are confronted with the issues of our modern day and ask us "...but why?". In Politics we equip them with the knowledge to know why. In lessons we aim to inspire students' curiosity to know more about the world around them and the way it is governed. We aim to train students to ask perceptive questions, think critically, weigh evidence, sift arguments, and develop perspective and judgement. Politics helps students to understand the complexity of society and government, the various forces and factors which influence politics and society, and the debates which have shaped and continue to shape the world we live in.

## Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in English Literature or English Language

## Course Content

| A Level                                      | %                                                                       | When?           | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Component 1:<br/>UK Politics</b>          | Written examination:<br>2 hrs<br>33⅓ % of the qualification<br>84 marks | June of Year 13 | <b>1. Political Participation</b><br>Democracy and participation<br>Political parties<br>Electoral systems<br>Voting behaviour and the media.<br><b>2. Core Political Ideas</b><br>Conservatism<br>Liberalism<br>Socialism.                                   |
| <b>Component 2:<br/>UK Government</b>        | Written examination:<br>2 hrs<br>33⅓ % of the qualification<br>84 marks | June of Year 13 | <b>1. UK Government</b><br>The constitution, Parliament, Prime Minister and executive, relationships between the branches.<br><b>2. Optional Political Ideas</b><br>One idea from the following: anarchism, ecology, feminism, multiculturalism, nationalism. |
| <b>Component 3:<br/>Comparative Politics</b> | Written examination:<br>33⅓ % of the qualification<br>84 marks          | June of Year 13 | The US Constitution and federalism, US congress, US presidency, US Supreme Court and civil rights, democracy and participation, Comparative theories.                                                                                                         |

## Costs associated with this course

We would recommend you buy the textbook for this course which is approximately £30. Trips are not a compulsory part of the A Level, but there may be trips run to the Houses of Parliament and costs associated with this.

## Career Links

Studying Politics can take you down multiple avenues. These include government, journalism, advertising, law, economics, the civil service, Economics, careers in business, public relations or human rights.

*For more information please contact Ms Butler*